

But I also knew that, as much wealth as Vanguard and our index funds may have created for investors, there were far more than 99 other individuals—many thousands more—who have had greater influence on contemporary society than I have had, and still millions of others who have received little or no recognition, yet have had an enormous and positive impact on their own communities. The fact is that most of those who make the greatest contributions to the daily working of our society never experience even a moment of the kind of fame that involves favorable recognition and public adulation.

And that brings us to *power*. Sure, few souls are more aware than I am of the thrill in having the power to run an enterprise. Exercised wisely, power over the *person* who serves the firm and power over the corporate *purse* are great fun, breeding self-confidence and the thrill of getting things done. But when power is used capriciously and arbitrarily, when power is reflected in grossly excessive perquisites, and when power is employed to create ego-building (and compensation-enhancing!) mergers and unwise capital expenditures that are more likely to detract from corporate value than to increase it, not only the shareholders of the corporation but its loyal employees—indeed society as a whole—are the losers.

What we ought to respect is power for a worthy purpose—the power of the intellect; the power of moral conduct; the power to enable the people with whom we work to grow in skill and spirit alike; the power that assures respect for the humblest to the highest souls who dedicate themselves to an enterprise; the power to help one's fellowman; power that is, using Adam Smith's ancient words, "[s]omething grand and beautiful and noble, well worth the toil and anxiety, to keep in motion the industry of mankind, to invent and improve the sciences and arts, which ennoble and embellish human life." Now *that's* power worth seeking.

So what are we to make of all of these mixed measures of success? Just this: Success cannot be measured solely—or even primarily—in monetary terms, nor in terms of the amount of power one may exercise over others, nor in the illusory fame of inevitably transitory public notice. But it *can* be measured in our contributions to building a better world, in helping our fellow man, and in raising